Example 3.1 Find the degree of each term for the following polynomial and also find the degree of the polynomial $6ab^8 + 5a^2b^3c^2 - 7ab + 4b^2c + 2$

Solution

Given polynomial is $6ab^8 + 5a^2b^3c^2 - 7ab + 4b^2c + 2$

Degree of each of the terms is given below.

$6ab^8$ has degree $(1+8) = 9$

$5a^2b^3c^2$ has degree $(2+3+2) = 7$

$7ab$ has degree $(1+1) = 2$

$4b^2c$ has degree $(2+1) = 3$

The constant term 2 is always regarded as having degree Zero.

The **degree** of the polynomial $6ab^8 + 5a^2b^3c^2 - 7ab + 4b^2c + 2$.

= the largest exponent in the polynomial

= 9

A very Special Polynomial

We have said that coefficients can be any real numbers. What if the coefficient is zero? Well that term becomes zero, so we won't write it. What if all the coefficients are zero? We acknowledge that it exists and give it a name.



It is the polynomial having all its coefficients to be zero.

$g(t) = 0t^4 + 0t^2 - 0t$, $h(p) = 0p^2 - 0p + 0$

From the above example we see that we cannot talk of the degree of the zero polynomial, since the above two have different degrees but both are zero polynomial. So we say that the degree of the zero polynomial is not defined.

The degree of the zero polynomial is not defined

Types of Polynomials

(i) Polynomial on the basis of number of terms	
MONOMIAL	A polynomial having one term is called a monomial Examples : 5, 6m, 12ab
BINOMIAL	A polynomial having two terms is called a Binomial Examples : $5x + 3$, $4a - 2$, $10p + 1$
TRINOMIAL	A polynomial having three terms is called a Trinomial Example : $4x^2 + 8x - 12$, $3a^2 + 4a + 10$

3 Algebra_Term1.indd 83 02/12/2022 21:38:45